

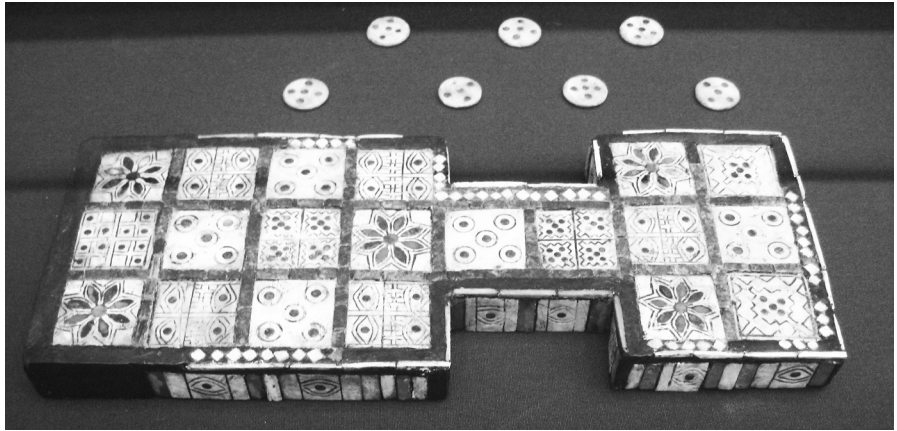


Figure 63-1: One of the five game boards found in the Royal Cemetery at Ur

Two players each begin with seven tokens in their home, and the first player to move all seven to the goal is the winner. Players take turns throwing four dice. These dice are four-pointed pyramid shapes called tetrahedrons. Each die has two marked points, giving an even chance that the dice come up marked or unmarked. Instead of dice, our game uses coins whose heads act as the marked point. The player can move a token one space for each marked point that comes up. This means they can move a single token between zero and four spaces, though they're most likely to roll two spaces.

The tokens travel along the path indicated in Figure 63-2. Only one token may exist on a space at a time. If a token lands on an opponent's token while in the shared middle path, the opponent's token is sent back home. If a token lands on the middle flower square, it is safe from being landed on. If a token lands on any of the other four flower tiles, the player gets to roll again. Our game will represent the tokens with the letters *X* and *O*.

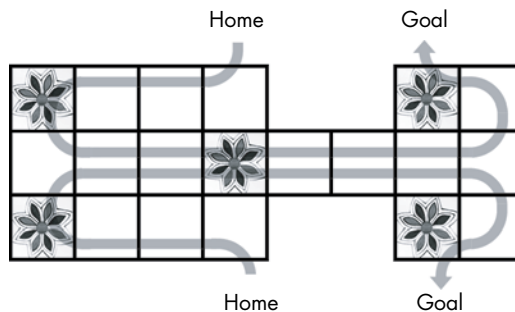


Figure 63-2: The path each player's token takes from their home to their goal

A video featuring YouTuber Tom Scott and British Museum curator Irving Finkel discussing the Royal Game of Ur can be found at <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WZskjLq040I>.